

Vital Sign Description — Assessment Rubric

This rubric evaluates a one-paragraph clinical description of a vital sign based on clinical accuracy, clarity, understanding, and professional communication.

Criterion	0 – Not Attempted	1 – Developing	2 – Proficient	3 – Exemplary
Clinical Accuracy	No clinical information or entirely incorrect description.	Provides a basic definition but includes incorrect or missing normal ranges with limited discussion of abnormalities.	Accurately describes the vital sign with correct normal range and identifies abnormal values with minor omissions.	Fully accurate description including correct normal ranges, abnormal thresholds, and clear clinical implications for patient care and triage.
Clarity and Professional Writing	Writing is unclear, disorganised, and contains major grammatical errors; not written in British English.	Some structure is present but grammar, tone, or clarity is inconsistent.	Clearly written with appropriate structure and mostly correct grammar using British English.	Highly clear, concise, and well-structured paragraph using consistent British English, appropriate clinical terminology, and professional tone.

Evidence of Understanding	No demonstration of understanding.	Provides a basic explanation with little connection to clinical context.	Demonstrates good understanding of the vital sign and its role in patient assessment.	Demonstrates strong understanding by explaining the clinical significance of abnormal values and linking the vital sign to real-world decision-making.
Coverage of Required Elements	Definition, normal ranges, and clinical relevance are missing.	Includes some elements but lacks completeness or clarity.	Includes definition, normal range, abnormal values, and basic triage use.	Fully covers all required elements: definition, normal range, abnormal conditions, and clear explanation of clinical/triage relevance.
Engagement and Effort	No submission or minimal effort shown.	Limited effort with incomplete or poorly structured response.	Adequate effort with a complete and structured paragraph.	Strong effort with a thoughtful, well-developed, and properly structured paragraph suitable for formal submission.

Total Points: _____/15

Grading Scale:

13–15 Distinction	10–12 Merit	6–9 Pass	0–5 Unsatisfactory
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Tutor feedback:

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